

Was the first iPhone any good? Not at all. It was almost a prototype that lacked even basic functions, and this caused other phone manufacturers to disregard it as a threat. What they didn't pay attention to was the touch interface that it offered. Almost every existing BlackBerry user laughed at the idea of giving up their hardware keyboard (many still stay with BlackBerry for that very reason), and other manufacturers saw the expensive iPhone as a niche market that would never affect their numbers.

To be fair to BlackBerry, you cannot really blame the company management too much for underestimating Apple. The initial teething problems with the iPhone aside, since Apple was "cool", and was advocating the smartness of their phones, it made sense for the world to start reading up about smartphones. At that time if you googled for "smartphone" you'd probably run into a BlackBerry link. So what did people do? Especially those who didn't want to jump to AT&T, or didn't live in the US, and didn't want to jailbreak one of the illegally imported locked iPhones? Why, buy a BlackBerry of course. We assume this is when ownership-bias crept in, and everyone bashed Apple's iPhone for being a joke of a smartphone.

Then the iPhone improved. Soon it wasn't a joke anymore. It had apps being developed for it, by the thousands! It became available all over the world across carriers and even unlocked. It had incredible resale value. Apple invested a lot in marketing the iPhone and providing service to customers. There was no complicated choosing of models to be done here. You wanted an iPhone? How many GB? Done. Every iPhone offered the same functionality, apps ran well, worked on any network. None of that BlackBerry

special data plan rubbish... well, you know how it is today.

DISRUPTIONS GALORE

The history of computing itself seems to be filled with disruptions. We've highlighted some of the most memorable ones thus far, but by no means is that an exhaustive list.

LCDs disrupted the CRT market. They started as low power, low performance things used in calculators, and now they're everywhere. It was slow in the beginning, but once LCDs started



BlackBerry was one of the first 'smartphones'

improving and gained accurate colour reproduction, that was it for CRTs.

The CD killed the floppy and zip drive market, and flash storage did the same to the CD in return. Cloud storage and increased bandwidth is now killing both of them...

Digital cameras were pathetic compared to film when they first came out. They were low-resolution, power hungry monsters that output terribly pixelated and often blurry images, because the sen-

sors were too slow, and a shaking hand would ruin most pictures. Then, sensors improved, resolutions went up, colour reproduction was better, and suddenly digital took off. No photography professional would be caught dead using a digital camera, because it implied that you weren't sure of your shot. It was meant for amateurs, who needed to click 300 pictures before getting one good one. It was for people who needed image editing in software before they could share a picture. Professionals would never stoop to that level... and then they did. Because as good as you are, you get better when you can immediately see what you've shot, and figure out ways of shooting it better and improving lighting, angles, etc. Today film is niche.

Another thing that's being disrupted is print media. Yes, we're all being slowly killed by digital. Some of us are fortunate to have a loyal reader-base like you, but most are not. Of course, being a technology magazine we've already got a website and there's an app coming soon (whoops! Don't tell anyone, it's still a secret...), but the fact is, print is officially niche. It's an indulgence for those who are fortunate enough and classy enough to still want to read something on paper. Like the people who still read books, magazine readers will never totally go away, but it's certainly not the most popular platform anymore, and it was, just a decade or so ago!

Facebook, Twitter, YouTube, WhatsApp and a tonne of other things can also be considered disruptions in their own right, but we'd need a 100 pages to talk about them all... enough of the history lesson, however, this was just to whet your appetite and get you to put your thinking cap on, to see if you can spot the disruptions that are coming soon... We've got a list of 10 that we're fairly confident about... 

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